Control is not correctness.

Why every agent needs a proof step — and what it costs to skip one.

10 slides · swipe

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A button press is not an invariant.

The agent clicked. The spinner spun. The toast fired. The backend never received the payload — or received it, and wrote nothing. The UI lied with confidence.

Control says 'I acted'.
Correctness says 'it happened'.

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Two signals every agent can read.

WEAK

UI feedback

spinner stopped
toast appeared
feels done

STRONG

State delta

field value changed
URL + DOM + network
backend counter moved

The second one is the only proof that matters.

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Why opencode-chrome exists.

62

MCP tools built from real verification failures

3

signals per click: DOM, network, storage

0

tools that assert anything without evidence

github.com/Muklller/opencode-chrome — every tool shipped because a click lied.

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The failure that taught me this.

Browser agent auto-submitted a form. Toast said 'Saved'. Database said nothing changed. Three hours of debugging a non-event. The click was perfect — the loop was missing.

Perfect clicks, wrong outcome.
Still your incident.

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The verify loop I write by hand.

01 Read the state before acting — target + neighbors



02 Act once — exactly one mutation



03 Read again — field, DOM, network, storage



04 Compare — if nothing moved, fail loudly

Every agent action ends in an assert or an apology.

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How to tell if your agent verifies or performs.

01 Does it re-read the page after every action?

02 Does it check the network tab, not just the toast?

03 Does it fail closed or open when the check is inconclusive?

04 Can it tell you WHY it thinks the step succeeded?

Three 'no's and you have a clicker, not an agent.

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What verification costs — and saves.

Verification adds latency and code. Skipping it adds incident reviews, rollback roulette, and users who can't trust anything. Cheap insurance, honest insurance.

Assert now.
Relax later.

The verification law.

An agent without a verify step is a random number generator with better marketing.

Correctness is not a feeling the model has — it's a fact the system checks.

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AGENTS · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next agent build.

Next agent you ship: before the first 'done', wire the state delta read. Save this list — your future postmortem will thank you.

Save for later review

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